CLASH ROYALE

RETENTION STRATEGY BREAKDOWN



ABOUT CLASH ROYALE

Clash Royale was released by Supercell in March 2016. The game maintained its ranking among the top-grossing strategy games and has since accumulated about 20 million net revenue (Clash Royale-Revenue and Download Estimates, 2020).



- **Battle Modes:** 1v1 or 2v2 battles.
- **Objective:** To Destroy the opponent's towers, especially the King's Tower for an instant win. Each team has a King's Tower accompanied by two Princess Towers.
- **Fighting Mechanism:** Players use cards to summon troops, buildings, and cast spells in battles. Cards, which come in Common, Rare, Epic, Legendary, and Champion rarities, can be obtained from battle and quest rewards, Clan exchange, or the store.
- **Scoring:** Destroying each tower will grant players a Crown while destroying the King's tower will grant three Crowns.
- **Match Duration:** Regular time - 3 minutes. Overtime: 2 minutes if tied or no Crowns are won.
- **Overtime Rules:** The first tower destroyed in overtime wins the battle. If still tied, towers rapidly lose health until one is destroyed.
- **Rewards: Crowns -** Collected in Crown Chest (opens with 10 Crowns). Trophies, Gold, and various rarity Chests are awarded for victories.



MAJOR GAME MECHANICS



Some cards of the Clash Royale Universe can be seen here

CARDS

- Players use cards to summon troops, buildings, and cast spells during battles. Cards can be collected from battle rewards, quest rewards, Clan exchanges, or store purchases.
- **Identical cards** can upgrade their level, with all cards capped at level 13.
- Cards can be of type **Common, Rare, Epic, Legendary, and Champion**.
- Players form a **deck of eight cards**, and **four cards** are **randomly selected** at the start of each battle.
- Players begin with **5 Elixir Points**, which replenish up to a maximum of 10 over time. Each card requires a **different amount of Elixir** to play, and after playing a card, a new one is drawn from the deck.

MAJOR GAME MECHANICS



CLAN PAGE

CLANS

- Clans can have up to **50 members**.
- Players can **join** or **form Clans** to trade cards and participate in **friendly battles** and **Clan Wars**.
- Clanmates can **donate cards** to each other and work together to fight Clan Wars. Once the player has completed the tutorial, they are allowed to join or create a Clan.
- However, the player must be at least King Level 3 to request cards. The player can initiate **Friendly Battles** in a Clan. One will not get any rewards from them, nor will they lose or gain Trophies.
- In a Clan, players can **share replays** from both their battle log and TV Royale.
- There are four different **roles** within a Clan: **Member, Elder, Co-Leader, and Leader**. Elders are the first level of promotion. They can kick Members out of the clan due to inactivity or other reasons.

MAJOR GAME MECHANICS



LANDING PAGE



1V1 BATTLE SCREEN

BATTLE

- Players square off in live competition(3 mins) on maps dotted by 6 buildings; 3 for each player: **2 Crown Towers and 1 King's Tower**.
- The objective of the battle is for the player to **destroy** the other player's **Crown Towers** (the big towers with Crowns on them) while protecting their own.
- A player may do this by deploying troops, buildings, and spells from a **deck of Cards** (drawn from a **Battle Deck** that they've created) anywhere within an allowable area which is the non-red space on the map.
- Cards are collected from **Chests** won in battles or bought in the **Shop**, allowing players to add new cards to their deck or **level up** existing ones.
- Each card requires **Elixir** to deploy, which **regenerates** over time, enabling continuous deployment of troops and spells.

RETENTION STRATEGIES

Players unlock higher levels of skill as they progress.



CARDS COLLECTION PAGE

- Players have to collect **duplicates** of the same card to upgrade it.
- As the level of the card increases it requires more and more cards to level it up as seen from the screenshot here.
- Upgraded cards are **more powerful** in terms of damage, hitpoints, speed, etc.
- Thus, players are motivated more to collect more cards by playing more games to upgrade and increase their chances of winning.

Rewards Retention - Chests



LANDING PAGE

- The **timed chests** are a major retention strategy of Clash Royale.
- Since chests have timers and **limited slots**, players need to pause their sessions and return to the game when the timers allow, as intended by the developers.
- The limited slots, chest timers, and the "only one chest can be opened at a time" mechanic create an **appointment system** that encourages players to **return for rewards**, potentially increasing **retention** if they value the chest's contents.

RETENTION STRATEGIES

Cooperative Play or a 2v2 Battle





2V2 BATTLE PAGE

- Two players play against two other players who can be a random teammate, a Clanmate, or a Friend.
- 2v2 battles have Season Token as a reward **without** putting **Trophies** at risk.
- This allows players who don't want to lose their trophies to play **without any risk.**
- This is the most popular mode for people who are just playing for fun with their friends.
- The ability to rematch (play another match) with the co-mate helps players to play **longer hours** without the fear of losing anything.

Trophies and Trophy Road

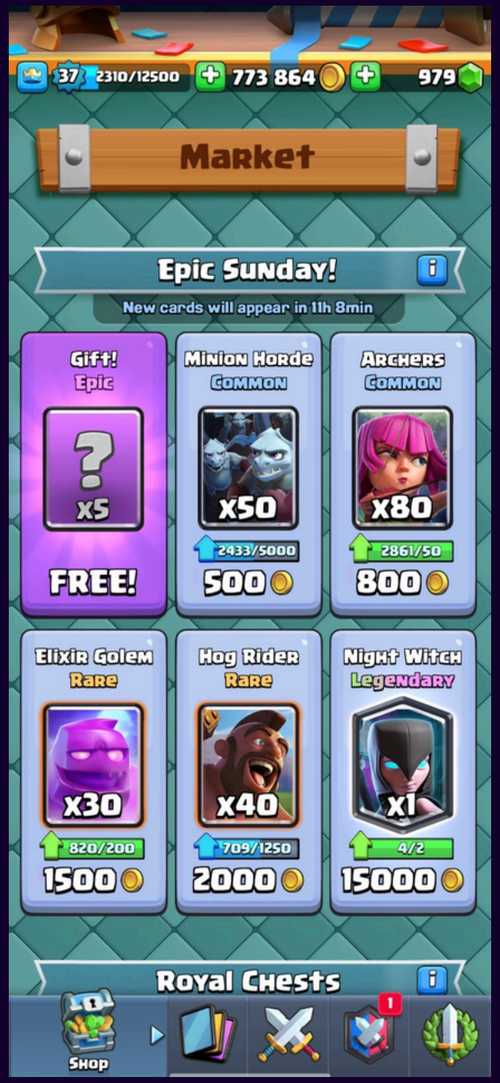


TROPHY ROAD

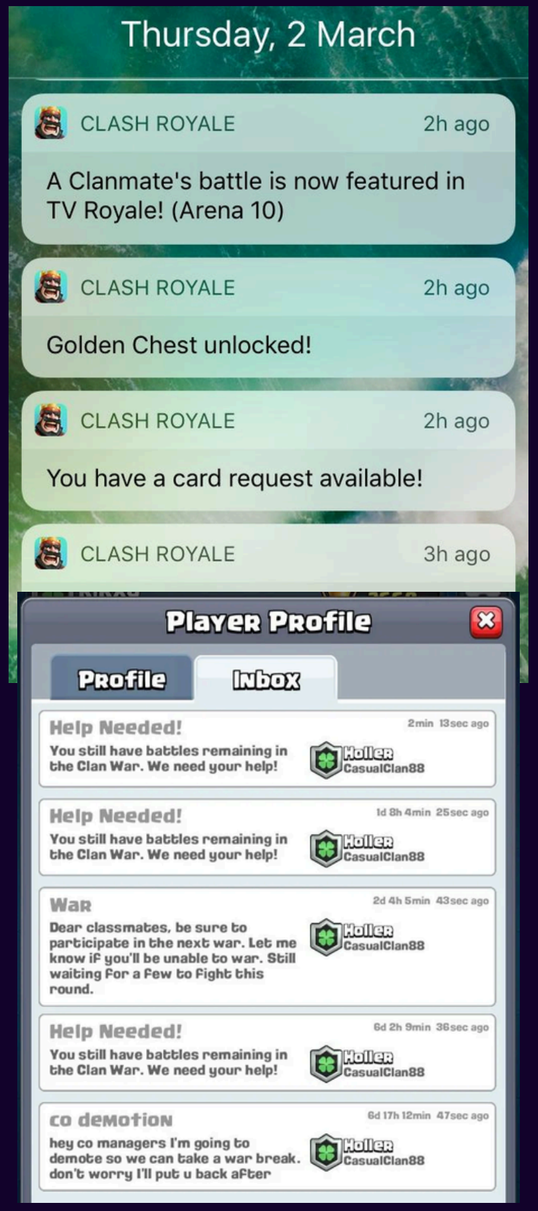
- Trophies indicate a player's or Clan's skill rating. Players can gain or lose Trophies by either winning or losing battles.
- Trophies you gain are deducted from your opponent's trophy count.
- Earning Trophies unlocks rewards via the Trophy Road, and unlocks new Arenas and cards.
- On the trophy road, you can see your friends' trophies too, which acts as a nudge for players to play more.
- Trophy Road is from 0-9000 and players gain one-time rewards after reaching different arenas.

RETENTION STRATEGIES

Shop and Market



- The Shop offers Cards, Chests, Gems, Gold, and occasionally Special Offers. Can be purchased with real money or in-game currency.
- **Every day** there are 6 offers present in the market; with **special offers** of getting an Epic Card every **Sunday**.
- This motivates players to **log in every day** and collect these rewards to get good cards at cheap rates.
- Even if a person plays a game or not he/she would visit the market just to make this purchase every day due to the **fear of missing out** good deals.



Notifications

- The game sends several alerts and reminders like these.
- The most common ones are <Chest type> Chest unlocked! and Join <player name> in a Clan Battle!
- There are **In-app notifications** too about the Clan Wars or when another player nudges you to contribute to the Clan Wars.
- For players who have not played for 3 days, ‘Battle awaits in the Arena!’
- Notifications are an important **nudge** for players to make them come back to the game; it could be for another chest, another battle, or a duty call from their Clan.

CONCLUSION

- **1. Long-term Engagement:** The **short** play sessions of 3 minutes and a variety of game modes nudge players to play more whenever time permits.

- **2. Strategic Gameplay:** The balanced card collection, allows for strategic thinking and satisfaction from defeating similarly skilled opponents.

- **3. Daily Tasks:** The numerous daily tasks make users feel **obligated** to log in frequently to avoid **missing rewards**.

- **4. Early Game Difficulty:** New players might struggle initially without spending money, feeling defeated by frequent losses and slow card upgrades. Despite these challenges, they continue to enjoy the gameplay and return to the game.




THANK YOU
FOR PARTICIPATING!